

Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7) — Paper 5

Chapter 6: क्रीडाम वयं श्लोकान्त्याक्षरीम् (Let Us Play Shloka-Antyakshari)

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)
Chapter	6 — क्रीडाम वयं श्लोकान्त्याक्षरीम् (Let Us Play Shloka-Antyakshari)
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. P5 traps: conflating savarṇa-dīrgha (श्लोक+अन्त्य→आ) with visarga→र् (निः+गन्ध, साधोः+विपरीतम्) and with the voiceless निः+फल→निष्फल branch; mistaking तादर्थ्ये चतुर्थी -आय datives of purpose for genitive/locative; swapping the विद्या-धन-शक्ति → विवाद-मद-परिपीडन (खल) vs ज्ञान-दान-रक्षण (साधु) aligned triple; reading the bare last varṇa instead of the last full akṣara (with its vowel-length) in the game; collapsing खल(moral)≠मूर्ख(intellect) and विद्या(studied)≠ज्ञान(realised); and treating the scentless किंशुक as a praised model rather than a warning. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A player closes a verse on the word धैर्यम्. To answer legally the next opener must echo the actual final akṣara of धैर्यम्, which is:

- (A) धै — the first syllable, because the opener always copies how the closing word begins
- (B) म् — the bare final consonant alone, since word-final vowels are always dropped
- (C) धैर्य — the whole stem before the case-ending, since the ending म् is discarded
- (D) र्यम् (rya-m) — the syllable य bearing र् as a pre-vocalic conjunct plus म्, i.e. the next verse must open on the यर्/र्य-coloured sound, since म् is a bare nasal closing the last full syllable र्य

2. A verse ends on the word गुरुः. By the game's syllable-rule, which proposed opener is LEGAL, and why?

- (A) रुचिरम्... — गुरुः ends in the full syllable रु (the visarga ः being only the nominative ending after it), so the opener must carry रु, which रुचिरम् supplies
- (B) गगनम्... — because the opener echoes the first syllable गु of गुरुः, here softened to ग

(C) विसर्गः... — because the very last mark heard is the visarga ः, and a word beginning विसर्ग- formally names it

(D) रुग्णः... is illegal while गृहम्... is legal, because only ग-initial words may answer a गुरुः- ending verse

3. Player P ends on the syllable तू (त् + long ऊ). Opponent offers a verse beginning तुरागः.... Is this legal?

(A) Legal — the consonant त matches, and the game never counts vowel length

(B) Legal — a long vowel may always be answered by its short counterpart, since they share one varṇa

(C) Illegal — तुरागः opens on तु (त् bearing SHORT उ), but the carried syllable तू holds a LONG ऊ; vowel-length is part of the akṣara and must be reproduced

(D) Illegal — but only because तुरागः is the name of a horse-word and animal-words are barred

4. In a four-player round the carried syllable becomes the rare cluster स्त्री (a single akṣara: स्+त्+र्+ई). Why is this the HARDEST kind of hand-over to answer?

(A) Because cluster-syllables are forbidden as endings, so the player who produced स्त्री automatically forfeits

(B) Because a verse must open on that exact triple-conjunct-plus-ई syllable, and very few known verses begin with so dense a cluster, so the supply of legal openers is tiny

(C) Because the next player may now open with any vowel, the cluster being unplayable and therefore waived

(D) Because the next player need only match the final vowel ई, making it in fact one of the easiest carries

5. Two children dispute the carry after a verse whose written close is ...विद्यां (anusvāra) but whose recited close sounds ...विद्या followed by a nasal hum. For the next opener, the game keys on:

(A) the anusvāra ँ alone, treated as a detachable final 'letter' to be matched by a ँ- initial word

(B) the syllable as actually recited — the open syllable द्या (with its long आ) that the next verse must begin on, since antyakshari is an oral, sound-keyed game

(C) the pre-recitation written form letter-by-letter, since spelling, not sound, is the authority

(D) the first syllable वि, because anusvāra endings reset the carry to the word's opening

6. A teacher notes antyakshari trains both memory and phonetic discrimination. The phonetic-discrimination claim, applied to this very chapter, is best shown by a player having to tell apart:

- (A) nothing phonetic at all — the player only needs to recall whole verses, the sounds being irrelevant
- (B) the meaning of निर्गन्ध from the meaning of शोभन्ते, since the game is a translation contest
- (C) the colour of the किंशुक from its scent, since the game tests botanical knowledge
- (D) the carry after ...निर्गन्धाः (final akṣara धाः → धा) from the carry after ...शोभन्ते (final akṣara ते) — different consonants AND vowels yielding different legal openers

7. P1 ends on मा; P2 must open on मा and chooses to end again on मा; P3 then ends on मा too. What does the rule imply about such a chain?

- (A) After two repeats the chain auto-resets and P3 may choose any syllable freely
- (B) P3 must switch to the FIRST syllable of P2's verse, because a syllable may never appear three times running
- (C) A syllable may legally recur indefinitely — each player simply matches the last heard syllable, so मा can be carried turn after turn with no 'no-repeat' bar
- (D) The round is void, since a repeated carry is treated as a failed hand-over

8. A player ends a verse on the word शक्तिः. Considering that शक्तिः ends in the short-i syllable ति followed by a visarga, the strictly correct next opener is one beginning on:

- (A) ती (long ī) — e.g. तीर्थम्..., since the visarga lengthens the preceding vowel before the seam
- (B) श — e.g. शरणम्..., echoing the first syllable श of शक्तिः
- (C) ति (short i) — e.g. a verse opening तिष्ठति..., reproducing the last vowel-bearing syllable ति, the visarga being only the case-ending after it
- (D) क्ति — a word opening on the medial conjunct क्ति, taken as the salient sound

9. The compound निष्कल (from निः + फल) and the chapter's निर्गन्ध (from निः + गन्ध) both begin with निः, yet the visarga surfaces differently. The reason is:

- (A) the trigger is the FOLLOWING sound — before the voiceless फ the visarga hardens to ष् (निष्कल), while before the voiced ग it becomes र् (निर्गन्ध); same निः, different following voicing
- (B) the difference is random; निः may be written either way with no rule governing the choice
- (C) निष्कल uses र् and निर्गन्ध uses ष्, the chapter simply printing them in reverse
- (D) both should be र्, so निष्कल is a misprint that ought to read निर्कल

10. At the seam श्लोक + अन्त्य → श्लोकान्त्य and at the seam महा + ईश → महेश, the two vowel sandhis are:

- (A) the same rule, since both simply join two vowels into one long vowel आ
- (B) both visarga sandhis, since each crosses a word-seam where a visarga is implied

(C) both guṇa sandhis, since every two-vowel junction in Sanskrit produces ए
(D) different — श्लोक+अन्त्य fuses two LIKE vowels (अ+अ→आ, savarṇa-dīrgha), whereas
महा+ईश fuses two UNLIKE vowels (आ+ई→ए, guṇa), so one lengthens and the other
forms a new guṇa vowel

11. A student writes the title-seam as श्लोकःअन्त्याक्षरी, claiming a hidden visarga is lost. The correct reply is:

- (A) correct — श्लोकः is the true stem and its visarga is deleted, leaving श्लोकान्त्य by visarga sandhi
- (B) correct — the र् in many sandhis comes from exactly such a hidden visarga, including this one
- (C) there is no visarga at the seam — श्लोक ends in the vowel अ, so श्लोक+अन्त्य is a VOWEL sandhi (अ+अ→आ), and inventing a visarga misclassifies the junction
- (D) partly correct — the seam is half visarga and half vowel sandhi acting together

12. Both साधोः + विपरीतम् → साधोर्विपरीतम् and पुनः + अपि → पुनरपि show a visarga becoming र्. The CONDITION shared by both is that the visarga stands before:

- (A) a voiced sound — before the voiced व (in विपरीतम्) and before the vowel अ (in अपि), the visarga regularly resolves to र्
- (B) a voiceless consonant, before which a visarga always hardens to र्
- (C) the specific letter प, which both following words happen to contain
- (D) a long vowel only, since र् appears solely before long vowels at a seam

13. Apply the chapter's visarga-resolution method to a NEW seam: निः + खः ('out + sound', i.e. soundless). The expected sandhi result is:

- (A) निर्वः — the visarga simply becomes a second र्, doubling before the following र
- (B) नीखः — visarga before र् drops and the preceding vowel lengthens (इ→ई), giving नीख ('without sound, silent')
- (C) निःखः — no change occurs, since a visarga is always retained before र
- (D) निप्रवः — the visarga becomes ष् before र, on the निष्प्रल pattern

14. The chapter-form निर्गन्धाः (plural, describing the किंशुक) versus the singular निर्गन्धम् पुष्पम् differ only in agreement. निर्गन्धाः agrees with its noun in being:

- (A) genitive plural — 'of the scentless ones', possessing the flowers
- (B) nominative PLURAL — matching किंशुकाः (nom. pl.), so 'the scentless किंशुक-flowers'
- (C) nominative singular — 'a scentless one', the long ā being merely decorative
- (D) accusative plural — the scentless flowers as the direct object of शोभन्ते

15. विद्याहीन is a तत्पुरुष whose first member hides a case. Applying the SAME analysis to धनहीन, its precise underlying form and sense are:

- (A) धनम् च हीनः च — a द्वन्द्व coordinating 'wealth and the lacking one'
- (B) धनेन हीनः — instrumental/separation, 'devoid OF / by-want-of wealth', the second member हीन governing the first

(C) धनस्य अधिकः — a comparative, 'exceeding wealth'

(D) धनम् हीनः — an accusative-object compound, 'lacking wealth as a direct object'

16. In the wicked half, विद्या विवादाय. Identify the case AND the precise reason for विवादायः

(A) dative (चतुर्थी), तादर्थ्ये चतुर्थी — the -आय marks PURPOSE, 'for the sake of quarrel', the very rule by which a goal-of-action takes the fourth case

(B) genitive (षष्ठी) — 'of quarrel', विवादाय marking possession of the quarrel by knowledge

(C) locative (सप्तमी) — 'in quarrel', placing the knowledge within a dispute

(D) ablative (पञ्चमी) — 'from quarrel', the knowledge arising out of a dispute

17. Across the GOOD half, the parallel forms are ज्ञानाय, दानाय, रक्षणाय. Mapping each to the gift whose good use it expresses, in the verse's fixed order विद्या-धन-शक्तिः

(A) विद्या → दानाय, धन → रक्षणाय, शक्ति → ज्ञानाय

(B) विद्या → ज्ञानाय (sharing of knowledge), धन → दानाय (giving), शक्ति → रक्षणाय (protection)

(C) विद्या → रक्षणाय, धन → ज्ञानाय, शक्ति → दानाय (D) विद्या → ज्ञानाय, धन → रक्षणाय, शक्ति → दानाय

18. In शक्तिः परेषाम् परिपीडनाय, three different cases appear on शक्तिः, परेषाम्, परिपीडनाय respectively. They are:

(A) all three nominative, as a list 'power, others, oppression'

(B) nominative (subject 'power'), genitive plural ('of others'), dative of purpose ('for oppression') — power [exists] for the oppression of others

(C) instrumental, accusative, locative — 'by power, the others, in oppression'

(D) dative, dative, dative — all three marking purpose together

19. Consider the new line शक्तिः रक्षणाय न तु पीडनाय, read by the verse's own grammar. It means:

(A) 'the power OF protection, not OF oppression' — both forms genitive

(B) 'power IN protecting, not IN oppressing' — both forms locative

(C) 'protect the power, do not oppress it' — both forms accusative objects

(D) 'power is FOR protection, NOT for oppression' — both -आय forms are datives of purpose contrasting two ends of the same gift

20. In विद्याहीनाः न शोभन्ते, why must the verb be शोभन्ते (3rd plural) rather than शोभते (3rd singular)?

(A) because the subject विद्याहीनाः is nominative PLURAL, and verb–subject agreement requires a 3rd-person PLURAL verb; a singular शोभते would clash with the plural subject

(B) because शोभते is past tense and the verse needs the present, the only difference being time

(C) because शोभन्ते is passive ('are made to shine') while शोभते is active

(D) because शोभन्ते addresses 'you all' and the verse speaks to the unlearned directly

21. क्रीडाम वयम् is a first-person plural exhortation 'let us play'. By the same morphology, the singular exhortation 'let me sing' (√गै/गा) would most faithfully be:

- (A) गायाम अहम् — keep the plural verb गायाम and merely swap वयम् for अहम्, the verb being fixed
- (B) गायतु सः — a third-person command 'let him sing', the standard singular of an exhortation
- (C) गायानि अहम् — a first-person SINGULAR exhortative, both the verb's person-number and the pronoun shifting together to one speaker
- (D) गायसि त्वम् — the second-person present, since 'let me' is addressed to oneself

22. How does क्रीडाम वयम् ('let us play') differ from the plain present क्रीडामः वयम् ('we play')? The difference is one of:

- (A) tense — क्रीडाम is past ('we played'), the dropped visarga marking past time
- (B) mood — क्रीडाम is an exhortative/wish form (a self-inclusive call to act), whereas क्रीडामः is a statement of ongoing fact; the change is in mood, not in tense or person
- (C) person — क्रीडाम is third person ('they play'), क्रीडामः first person
- (D) voice — क्रीडाम is passive ('it is played by us'), क्रीडामः active

23. From यशस् ('fame') the chapter builds यशस्वी / यशस्विनी ('endowed with fame'). By the SAME possessive pattern, a single word for 'a man endowed with intellect (मेधा)' would be:

- (A) अमेधस् — the privative 'intellect-less', the negative prefix marking possession
- (B) मेधाय — the dative 'for intellect', the -आय ending marking the possessor
- (C) मेधाहीन — the हीन-compound, here meaning 'full of intellect'
- (D) मेधावी — the possessive -विन् suffix on the quality-stem, 'one having intellect'

24. विद्यालय (विद्या + आलय) and विद्याहीन (विद्या + हीन) both start with विद्या, yet are different compound TYPES. Correctly:

- (A) both are द्वन्द्व compounds, simply listing 'learning and a house' / 'learning and lack'
- (B) विद्यालय is a बहुव्रीहि ('the learned one') and विद्याहीन a तत्पुरुष
- (C) विद्यालय is a तत्पुरुष meaning 'abode of learning' (a place), while विद्याहीन is a तत्पुरुष meaning 'devoid of learning' (a quality) — both dependent compounds but the second member differs in sense
- (D) विद्यालय is an अव्ययीभाव ('near learning') and विद्याहीन a द्वन्द्व

25. भारभूत is glossed as भारकर. Analysing भार + भूत against भार + कर, the two agree in meaning because:

- (A) भूत means 'ghost' and कर means 'hand', so both literally mean 'a burden's ghostly hand'
- (B) भूत is the past participle 'having become' and कर the agentive 'making/causing', so 'become-a-burden' and 'burden-causing' both pick out a person who IS or imposes a burden
- (C) भूत means 'the earth' and कर means 'tax', so both mean 'the earth's tax'
- (D) भूत and कर are unrelated roots, so the two glosses cannot really mean the same thing

26. In किंशुकाः इव, the standard-of-comparison किंशुकाः stands in the nominative plural. The grammatical reason is that इवः

- (A) forces the following word into the accusative as its direct object
- (B) forces the following word into the instrumental, as the means of comparison
- (C) forces the following word into the genitive, as 'belonging to' the comparison
- (D) is an indeclinable comparison-particle that assigns NO case of its own, so the upamāna किंशुकाः simply matches the upameya विद्याहीनाः in nominative plural

27. Why is translating किंशुक merely as 'a lovely red flower' (dropping its scentlessness) a SUBSTANTIVE error in the simile, not a mild one?

- (A) because it exaggerates the flower's rarity, making the comparison sound boastful
- (B) because it turns the flower into the subject and the person into the object, reversing the comparison
- (C) because it equates knowledge with fragrance as the same physical substance
- (D) because the simile's whole force is a LACK — splendid outside, empty inside; deleting the scentlessness removes the missing quality, so the verse would wrongly imply the unlearned person lacks nothing and there is nothing to criticise

28. Apply the किंशुक simile's reading-method to a NEW image: a counterfeit gold coin — bright, coin-shaped, but worthless metal within. Mapped onto the verse's logic, the coin's gleam corresponds to _____ and its base metal to _____:

- (A) the किंशुक's scent ... the किंशुक's colour, since a coin's value is in its surface
- (B) विद्या (knowledge) ... शीलम् (character), since both are inner goods present in the coin
- (C) the साधु's giving ... the खल's pride, since coins are about wealth
- (D) the किंशुक's colour (outward splendour) ... the किंशुक's scentlessness (the missing inner worth that विद्या/शीलम् would supply)

29. Reconstruct the किंशुक verse's teaching as a faithful conditional:

- (A) 'If a person is beautiful, then विद्या is no longer needed for that person to shine'
- (B) 'If a person has विद्या, then outward beauty is guaranteed to follow'
- (C) 'If a person lacks विद्या, then outward beauty ALONE cannot make that person truly shine' — beauty without knowledge is colour without scent
- (D) 'If a person lacks beauty, then no amount of विद्या can help that person shine'

30. The साधारणधर्म (common property) that licenses the comparison विद्याहीनाः ~ किंशुकाः is best stated as:

- (A) 'literally red in colour' — the property of being the same hue, shared by person and flower
- (B) 'splendid in appearance yet void of the inner essence that gives real worth' — abstracted from the flower's colour-without-scent

(C) 'found growing in forests' — both the unlearned and the किंशुक belonging to wild places

(D) 'richly fragrant' — a quality both the cultured person and the flower possess in abundance

31. A brilliant judge knows every law by heart but twists rulings to ruin honest litigants for a bribe. By the chapter's categories, he is a _____, and his विद्या serves _____:

(A) मूर्ख (a fool) ... ज्ञान-sharing — anyone who acts badly must really be ignorant

(B) साधु (a good man) ... रक्षण (protection) — because deep learning automatically confers character

(C) किंशुक (a flower) ... दान (giving) — because his eloquence is fragrant and generous

(D) खल (a moral failing of will, learned but corrupt) ... विवाद / harm — his knowledge is turned to wrongdoing, so despite learning his worth is low for lack of शीलम्

32. Distinguish three men by the chapter's labels: A is unlettered but kind and honest; B is a learned orator who knowingly incites riots; C is a learned, generous teacher. Respectively they are:

(A) A a खल, B a मूर्ख, C a साधु — since a learned man like B cannot be wicked

(B) A a मूर्ख (intellectual lack, no malice), B a खल (gifts wilfully turned to harm), C a साधु (learning rightly used)

(C) A a साधु, B a साधु, C a खल — kindness and learning both making one good regardless of use

(D) all three खल, since each falls short of perfection in some way

33. Which scenario is internally CONSISTENT with the chapter's विद्या-vs-ज्ञान distinction?

(A) an unschooled forest sage possesses deep realised insight (ज्ञान) while a heavily-degreed scholar of much studied learning (विद्या) lacks that inner realisation

(B) a man with much formal विद्या must, by that fact alone, possess equal ज्ञान

(C) ज्ञान can be acquired only inside a विद्यालय, so no unschooled person can ever have it

(D) विद्या and ज्ञान are interchangeable, so claiming one without the other is a contradiction

34. Why does the wicked-vs-good verse deliberately name the खल, and not the मूर्ख, as the one who turns gifts to harm?

(A) because misusing gifts is a CHOSEN, ill-willed act — a fault of WILL, which defines the खल — whereas the मूर्ख's defect is intellectual and need not involve any chosen misuse

(B) because the मूर्ख possesses no gifts at all (knowledge, wealth, power) to be misused

(C) because खल and मूर्ख are synonyms, so either word would have served equally

(D) because the मूर्ख is the same as the साधु and is therefore praised, not blamed

35. Identify the man who is a मूर्ख but NOT a खल:

- (A) a minister who twists the law to imprison his rivals
- (B) a trader who knowingly cheats every customer
- (C) a kindly village elder who keeps giving harmful advice on matters he never studied, meaning no harm at all
- (D) a scholar who spreads lies to spark riots

36. A man is धनवान् (rich), रूपवान् (handsome) and कुलीन (high-born), yet cruel and dishonest. The chapter's verdict, with its single decisive reason, is:

- (A) he is a भारभूतः — a burden on the earth — because he LACKS शीलम्, the one quality that confers real worth, however much else he has
- (B) he is fully worthy, since wealth, looks and birth together outweigh the absence of शीलम्
- (C) he is a साधु, because high birth (कुलम्) by itself secures good character
- (D) he is a किंशुक — worthy — because his handsomeness supplies the scent the flower lacks

37. Two cousins share equal wealth and equal good looks; one is honest and generous, the other deceitful and grasping. The chapter says their difference in worth is decided by:

- (A) धनम् (wealth) — being exactly equal, it is precisely what tips the balance
- (B) रूपम् (beauty) — being equal, it must therefore be the decisive factor
- (C) शीलम् (character) — the honest cousin has it, the deceitful one lacks it; the equal wealth and looks cannot decide between them
- (D) कुलम् (birth) — assumed to differ and so settles the matter

38. Place the chapter's value-hierarchy in correct DESCENDING order of what confers true worth:

- (A) लक्ष्मीः and रूपम् above शीलम् and विद्या (B) कुलम् (birth) alone above everything else
- (C) रूपम् (beauty) above all, since the verse celebrates the किंशुक's brilliant colour
- (D) शीलम् (character) and विद्या (well-used knowledge) ABOVE रूपम् (beauty), लक्ष्मीः (wealth) and कुलम् (birth)

39. A wealthy woman quietly funds a free school for poor children. Mapped onto the verse, and judged by the chapter, she:

- (A) uses her धन for मद (pride), since any spending of wealth is a display of arrogance
- (B) shows no relevant quality, since the verse speaks only of विद्या, never of wealth
- (C) becomes a भारभूता, because depleting wealth burdens the earth's resources
- (D) uses her धन for दान (the good use of wealth), evidencing the शीलम् that confers real worth

40. लक्ष्मीः, the chapter's word for wealth/fortune personified, is grammatically feminine. The fact that best confirms this within the verse-vocabulary's own logic is that:

- (A) it is declined throughout as an ī-stem feminine, taking feminine concord like नदी / यशस्विनी, the final visarga being merely the nominative-singular ending
- (B) it ends in a visarga (ः), and all visarga-final words are masculine
- (C) it denotes an abstract quality, and all abstractions in Sanskrit are neuter
- (D) it is derived from a verb, and all verbal nouns are masculine

41. Which of these is a TRUE statement about the chapter (the other three are false)?

- (A) विपरीतम् is the hinge-word that flips each gift's use between the खल and the साधु
- (B) the किंशुक is offered as a model to imitate, because its fragrance proves its inner worth
- (C) शीलम् is glossed as धनम् / लक्ष्मीः, i.e. wealth
- (D) खल and मूर्ख are two words for the very same kind of bad person

42. If the contrast-word were changed from विपरीतम् ('opposite') to समानम् ('same'), giving खलस्य साधोश्च समानम्, the verse's teaching would become:

- (A) stronger — समानम् would intensify the contrast between them
- (B) unchanged — समान and विपरीत carry the same sense in this context
- (C) a teaching about flowers rather than about people
- (D) false to its intent — it would now wrongly claim the wicked and the good use the very same gifts in the SAME way

43. वि- in विपरीतम् and निर्- in निर्गन्ध are both prefixes but contribute DIFFERENT senses. Correctly:

- (A) both give 'absence', so विपरीत means 'without a path' and निर्गन्ध 'without scent'
- (B) both give 'intensity', so विपरीत means 'very near' and निर्गन्ध 'very fragrant'
- (C) वि- here gives 'reversal / opposition' (turned the other way), while निर्- gives 'absence / privation' (without)
- (D) वि- gives 'privation' and निर्- gives 'reversal', so the two senses are simply swapped

44. The chapter-word रूपवान् ('possessing beauty') and यशस्विनी ('possessing fame') illustrate the same word-building idea, namely:

- (A) a possessive suffix (-वत्/-वान्, -विन्) attached to a quality-stem (रूप, यशस्) to mean 'one endowed WITH that quality'
- (B) a privative prefix meaning 'one WITHOUT that quality'
- (C) a dative ending meaning 'for the sake of that quality'
- (D) a comparative suffix meaning 'more beautiful / more famous than another'

45. खलस्य and साधोः in the contrast-clause are genitives. The job of the genitive here is to mark:

- (A) the RECIPIENT — 'to the wicked' / 'to the good' (a dative sense)
- (B) the SOURCE — 'from the wicked' / 'from the good' (an ablative sense)

(C) WHOSE handling of the gifts is in view — 'of the wicked' / 'of the good', i.e. the wicked's use versus the good's use

(D) DIRECT ADDRESS — 'O wicked one!' / 'O good one!' (a vocative sense)

46. Why can a person be a विद्वान् (a learned, lettered person) and yet, by the chapter's measure, count as worthless?

(A) because विद्या without शीलम् — or विद्या misused as विवाद — leaves a person a भारभूतः; learning alone does not confer worth

(B) because a truly learned person can never, by definition, be judged worthless

(C) because acquiring विद्या automatically destroys one's शीलम्

(D) because only wealth, never learning or character, can confer any worth at all

47. The verse's logic that 'the same gift serves harm in the wicked and good in the साधु' is an instance of which general moral idea?

(A) that gifts are morally NEUTRAL in themselves; their value is decided by the character and intent of the one who wields them

(B) that some gifts (like power) are inherently evil and others (like knowledge) inherently good

(C) that the wicked never truly possess any gift, so the comparison is only apparent

(D) that gifts automatically improve whoever holds them, wicked or good alike

48. A person of great शक्ति uses it solely to shield the weak from harm. By the verse this is शक्ति → रक्षण; therefore the chapter would say his power has made him:

(A) act as a खल, because wielding great power at all is itself oppression

(B) a भारभूतः, because the powerful are always a burden on the earth

(C) a किंशुक, because protection is mere outward show like the flower's colour

(D) act as a साधु, because he turns power to its GOOD use (protection of others), the very opposite of परिपीडन

49. A debater argues: 'दान and मद both arise from धन, so the verse must treat them alike.' The strongest rebuttal is:

(A) they share the same SOURCE (wealth) but are OPPOSITE outcomes — दान gives outward to others, मद clutches inward as pride; same gift, विपरीत use, exactly the verse's point

(B) they are indeed alike, since any two things stemming from wealth are equivalent

(C) दान and मद do not come from धन at all, so the premise is simply false

(D) दान and मद come from विद्या and शक्ति respectively, not from धन

50. Which chain of reasoning is FULLY consistent with the chapter, start to finish?

(A) 'He has विद्या → therefore he shines → therefore he must be a साधु, whatever he does with it'

(B) 'He has विद्या but turns it to starting quarrels → his use of it is विवाद → he acts as a खल → because he lacks शीलम्, his true worth is low'

(C) 'He is rich and handsome → therefore he has शीलम् → therefore he is worthy'

(D) 'He is scentless like a किंशुक → therefore he is wise → therefore he is worthy'

51. Synthesising the किंशुक verse with the शीलम् verse, the single principle they JOINTLY establish is:

(A) outward splendour is itself the highest good, and inner qualities are decorative extras

(B) knowledge and character matter only for those who happen to lack beauty and wealth

(C) outward splendour (colour, looks, wealth) without an inner good (knowledge, character) is empty — worth is decided by the inner quality and by the USE to which gifts are put

(D) the किंशुक verse praises wealth while the शीलम् verse praises beauty

52. A classmate asserts: 'किंशुक just means any pretty flower, and खल and मूर्ख are simply two words for the same kind of bad person.' The single best correction is:

(A) the classmate is right about both points

(B) किंशुक names the specific bright-but-SCENTLESS Flame of the Forest (the scentlessness drives the simile), and खल (a moral, ill-willed fault) is distinct from मूर्ख (an intellectual fault)

(C) किंशुक is indeed any pretty flower, but खल and मूर्ख do differ

(D) किंशुक is the Flame of the Forest, but खल and मूर्ख do mean the same

53. A player, stuck for a continuation, proposes a verse opening with the vowel-syllable आ after a verse that ended on the consonant-syllable क्. The move is:

(A) illegal — the opener must echo the carried consonant-syllable, and a vowel-initial verse does not reproduce that consonant onset

(B) legal — a vowel may freely substitute for any required consonant-syllable

(C) legal — because verses ending on a bare consonant let the next player open with anything

(D) illegal — but only because vowel-initial verses are forbidden in the game entirely

54. A player closes on the word रक्षणाय (the dative of रक्षण). For the next opener, the carried final syllable is:

(A) र — the first syllable of रक्षणाय, since the opener copies the word's beginning

(B) णा — the penultimate syllable, since the final -य is a mere dative ending to be dropped

(C) क्ष — the medial conjunct, taken as the most prominent sound

(D) य (the bare consonant-onset syllable closing णाय, i.e. the next verse opens on a या/य-coloured sound) — the actual last syllable of रक्षणाय, not its case-stem

55. Why does the antyakshari rule pick the last AKṢARA (syllable) rather than the last VARṆA (single sound) as the opener-target?

- (A) because individual varṇas cannot be pronounced at all in Sanskrit
- (B) because the last sound is always a vowel, making 'syllable' and 'single sound' identical here
- (C) because a Sanskrit syllable normally bundles a consonant with its vowel, and verses naturally begin on such syllables — so matching whole syllables keeps the required opener a real, recitable verse-start
- (D) because varṇa and akṣara are unrelated and the rule simply picks one at random

56. A man memorises whole śāstras yet deploys them only to entrap honest people. The chapter's joint verdict on his TYPE and his WORTH is:

- (A) a मूर्ख, since anyone who behaves badly must by definition be unwise and ignorant
- (B) a साधु, since deep learning automatically confers good character
- (C) a खल — learned but morally corrupt — whose real worth is LOW because, lacking शीलम्, his विद्या serves विवाद
- (D) worthy and admirable, since his विद्या alone guarantees high worth

57. The whole chapter reduces to one governing principle. Which states it most precisely?

- (A) more gifts (wealth, looks, power) always mean more worth
- (B) the worth of any gift or trait is fixed by the inner quality behind it (knowledge, character) and the use to which it is put — not by the gift itself
- (C) outward beauty and wealth are by themselves sufficient for a worthy life
- (D) knowledge alone, however it is used, guarantees worth

58. Compare two givers: the साधु gives wealth away as दान; the खल hoards and flaunts it as मद. The DEEPEST difference the verse points to is not the amount but:

- (A) the amount of wealth each holds, the larger fortune being the more virtuous
- (B) the direction and intent of use — दान flows OUTWARD to others, मद turns INWARD as self-glorifying pride
- (C) the source from which each acquired the wealth
- (D) the colour or form of the wealth, as with the किंशुक's hue

59. Apply the verse's तदर्थ्ये-चतुर्थी method to a NEW phrase: ज्ञानम् मुक्तये ('knowledge ... liberation'). Reading मुक्तये by the verse's grammar, the phrase means:

- (A) 'the knowledge OF liberation' — मुक्तये as a genitive of possession
- (B) 'knowledge IN liberation' — मुक्तये as a locative of place
- (C) 'liberation BY knowledge' — मुक्तये as an instrumental of means
- (D) 'knowledge is FOR liberation' — मुक्तये is a dative of purpose (मुक्ति in the fourth case), exactly like विवादाय/दानाय

60. Which single sentence most faithfully captures what makes a person worthy, according to the whole chapter?

- (A) लक्ष्मी (wealth) and रूप (beauty) together make a person worthy above all else
- (B) कुल (high birth) by itself is what makes a person worthy

(C) विद्या rightly used together with शीलम् (good character) makes a person worthy — not रूप, लक्ष्मी or कुल by themselves

(D) यशस् (fame), however it is gained, is what makes a person worthy

Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 6: क्रीडाम वयं श्लोकान्त्याक्षरीम् (Let Us Play Shloka-Antyakshari) — Paper 5

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	D	11	C	21	C	31	D	41	A	51	C
2	A	12	A	22	B	32	B	42	D	52	B
3	C	13	B	23	D	33	A	43	C	53	A
4	B	14	B	24	C	34	A	44	A	54	D
5	B	15	B	25	B	35	C	45	C	55	C
6	D	16	A	26	D	36	A	46	A	56	C
7	C	17	B	27	D	37	C	47	A	57	B
8	C	18	B	28	D	38	D	48	D	58	B
9	A	19	D	29	C	39	D	49	A	59	D
10	D	20	A	30	B	40	A	50	B	60	C

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (D) Antyakshari hands over the last PRONOUNCED syllable, not the first syllable of the closing word, so copying घै is wrong. A bare consonant ण् is not itself a recitable verse-opener and cannot be matched alone, so taking only ण् fails. Discarding the whole inflectional body to keep only the 'stem' is not a game rule. The operative final syllable here is the र्ये-bearing unit that ण् closes, and that conjunct-coloured syllable is what the continuation must reproduce.

2. (A) The carried unit is the last vowel-bearing syllable रु; the trailing visarga is merely the case-ending and cannot itself start a word, so naming the visarga is not a move. The opener must echo the END of the previous verse, not its opening गु, so a ग-initial reply is the wrong target. रुचिस्म् opens on रु and is therefore the legal continuation; the claim that only ग-initial words may answer simply misreads which end is matched.

3. (C) A Sanskrit syllable bundles a consonant with a SPECIFIC vowel, and that vowel's length is intrinsic to the syllable; matching त alone while ignoring ऊ vs उ is exactly the precision the game enforces, so 'length never counts' is false. Long and short vowels are distinct units, so a short reply does not satisfy a long carry. There is no rule barring animal-words; the sole defect is the ऊ/उ mismatch.

4. (B) Difficulty in antyakshari is a supply problem: the rarer the required opening syllable, the fewer remembered verses begin with it. Ending on a cluster is not forbidden and triggers no automatic forfeit. The rule is never relaxed to a free vowel just because the carry is awkward. And the carry is the WHOLE akṣara स्त्री, not merely its final vowel ई, so reducing it to 'match ई' misstates the rule and would make it spuriously easy.

5. (B) Antyakshari is recited aloud, so it keys on the heard sound; the operative carry is the open syllable द्या. An anusvāra is a nasalisation mark, not a stand-alone opener, so no word 'begins with ँ'. Spelling is not the operative authority over sound in an oral game. And nothing in the rule shifts the carry to the word's FIRST syllable वि — that confuses the start with the end.

6. (D) The game forces a player to isolate and reproduce the precise final syllable; धा and ते differ in both consonant and vowel, so they demand different openers — exactly the phonetic discrimination claimed. The game is not meaning-free recall, since the wrong opener is rejected on sound; it is not a translation contest; and it tests recitation, not botany.

7. (C) The rule only ever inspects the LAST syllable just heard; if it is again मा, the next player must again open on मा, and nothing caps repetition. There is no reset-after-N rule, no switch to a verse's first syllable, and a legal repeat is not a failed hand-over — it is a perfectly valid (if monotonous) continuation.

8. (C) The carried syllable is the last pronounceable one, ति with a SHORT i; the visarga is the nominative ending and does not lengthen the vowel, so a long-ī opener like तीर्थम् mismatches the vowel. The opener echoes the verse's END, not its first syllable श. The medial conjunct क्ति is internal, not the final syllable, so opening on it is wrong. Only a ति-opener faithfully carries the heard final syllable.

9. (A) Visarga sandhi is conditioned by the following sound: a voiced consonant such as ग yields र् (निर्गन्ध), whereas the voiceless फ yields the sibilant ष् (निष्फल). The outcome is therefore rule-governed, not random, and the two forms are not reversed. निष्फल is the correct output before फ, not a misprint for निर्फल — treating both as र् ignores the voiced/voiceless split.

10. (D) श्लोक ends in अ and अन्त्य begins in अ — two LIKE vowels merging to a long आ (savarna-dīrgha). महा ends in आ and ईश begins in ई — UNLIKE vowels merging to the guṇa vowel ए. So they are different mechanisms: one is vowel-lengthening, the other guṇa-

formation. Neither involves a visarga, and not every junction yields ए — that overgeneralises guṇa to like-vowel cases where lengthening, not guṇa, applies.

11. (C) श्लोक is an अ-ending stem, not a visarga-ending one; its junction with अन्त्य is a like-vowel lengthening (savarna-dīrgha), giving श्लोकान्त्य. There is no visarga to delete here, so the 'hidden visarga' premise is false. Visarga-to-र् changes (as in निर्गन्ध) belong to genuinely visarga-ending stems, not to this अ-ending one, and a seam is governed by one operative rule, not a 'half-and-half' blend.

12. (A) Both seams place the visarga before a VOICED sound — व and the vowel अ — and voiced environments trigger the र् outcome; this is the shared condition. It is not a voiceless trigger (that branch behaves differently, e.g. ष्/sibilants). It is not attraction to प (which is voiceless and not even the seam-sound in पुनरपि). And it is not restricted to long vowels — अ in अपि is short.

13. (B) When a visarga meets a following र्, the visarga is dropped and the preceding short vowel lengthens to avoid a र्-र् cluster, giving नीरव. It does not double into र् (निर्व), the visarga is not retained unchanged before र्, and the ष्-outcome belongs to voiceless फ/प-type environments (निष्फल), not before र्. The privative निः- still yields the sense 'without sound', i.e. silent.

14. (B) निर्गन्धाः carries the nominative-plural ending and qualifies किंशुकाः, the nominative-plural standard of comparison, so it is nom. pl. — 'scentless flowers'. It is not a genitive 'of', and the -आः is a real plural ending, not decoration on a singular. शोभन्ते is intransitive ('shine'), taking no object, so an accusative reading has nothing to govern the flowers as objects.

15. (B) हीन ('devoid of') governs its complement in the instrumental/separation sense, so धनहीन resolves to धनेन हीनः — 'lacking by want of wealth' — exactly parallel to विद्यया हीनः. It is a dependent तत्पुरुष, not a coordinate द्वन्द्व listing two items; it is not a comparative 'exceeding'; and हीन does not take an accusative object here.

16. (A) विवादाय is the dative of purpose: the rule तादर्थ्ये चतुर्थी puts the END/goal of an action in the fourth case, so knowledge exists 'for the sake of' quarrel. It is not a genitive of possession ('of quarrel'), not a locative of place ('in quarrel'), and not an ablative of source ('from quarrel') — each of those would misread a purpose-dative as something else.

17. (B) Each good use belongs to the SAME gift whose wicked use it opposes: knowledge → spreading-knowledge (vs quarrel), wealth → giving (vs pride), power → protection (vs oppression). The other arrangements cross the gifts — pairing wealth with protection or power with giving — which breaks the within-gift opposition the verse is built on. Only knowledge↔ज्ञान, wealth↔दान, power↔रक्षण keeps the triple aligned.

18. (B) शक्तिः is the nominative subject; परेषाम् is the genitive plural of पर ('of others'), telling whom the oppression targets; परिपीडनाय is the dative of purpose ('for oppression').

They are NOT all nominative (that would make three subjects), not the mixed instrumental/accusative/locative set, and not all datives — only परिपीडनाय expresses purpose; परेषाम् expresses the relation 'of others'.

19. (D) रक्षणाय and पीडनाय are datives of purpose, just like the verse's विवादाय/दानाय, so the line opposes two AIMS of power — protection versus oppression. They are not genitives ('of'), not locatives ('in'), and not accusative objects; reading them as anything but purpose-datives loses the 'for X, not for Y' contrast.

20. (A) Sanskrit verbs agree with their subject in number and person; विद्याहीनाः is 3rd-person nominative plural, so the verb must be 3rd plural शोभन्ते — a singular शोभते would not agree. Both शोभते and शोभन्ते are present, so the issue is number, not tense. शोभन्ते here is the intransitive 'they shine', not a passive 'are made to shine'. And it is 3rd person (about them), not 2nd person 'you all'.

21. (C) Just as क्रीडाम्/वयम् are matched first-person PLURAL, a first-person SINGULAR exhortation needs BOTH the verb and pronoun to be singular: गायानि अहम्. Keeping a plural verb गायाम् with a singular pronoun अहम् breaks agreement. A third-person गायतु सः means 'let HIM sing', not 'let me'. And a second-person present गायसि त्वम् is an ordinary 'you sing', not a self-exhortation.

22. (B) The contrast is between an exhortative MOOD ('let us play') and an indicative statement ('we play') — both first-person plural, both present-time in reference, so it is neither a tense change (not past), nor a person change (both are first-person 'we'), nor a voice change (neither is passive). The mood alone shifts a report into an invitation.

23. (D) The possessive suffix -विन्/-वत् attached to a quality-stem means 'endowed with', so मेधा → मेधावी, exactly parallel to यशस् → यशस्वी. अमेधस् is the OPPOSITE (lacking intellect). A dative मेधाय means 'for intellect', not 'possessing it'. And मेधाहीन means 'devoid of intellect', not 'full of' it — the हीन-compound is privative, not possessive.

24. (C) Both are dependent (तत्पुरुष) compounds whose first member विद्या is governed by the second: आलय gives 'abode OF learning' (a school), हीन gives 'devoid OF learning'. Neither is a द्वन्द्व listing two coordinate things. विद्यालय names a place, not a person, so it is not a बहुव्रीहि 'the learned one'. And neither is an अव्ययीभाव adverbial compound.

25. (B) Here भूत is the participle 'become' (भारभूत = 'having become a burden') and कर is the agentive 'causing' (भारकर = 'burden-causing'); both describe one who is, or imposes, a burden, so the gloss is exact. भूत is not 'ghost' and कर not 'hand' in this compound; भूत is not 'the earth' nor कर 'tax'; and the two are deliberately equivalent, not unrelated.

26. (D) इव is an indeclinable; it does not govern a case, so the compared standard takes whatever case its counterpart has — here किंशुकाः matches the nominative-plural विद्याहीनाः. It does not put the next word in the accusative, instrumental, or genitive; treating इव as a case-governing word is the misconception each wrong option encodes.

27. (D) The किंशुक is invoked precisely because it is bright BUT scentless; the साधारणधर्म (shared property) is 'glorious appearance, no inner essence'. Drop the scentlessness and the flower seems flawless, so the unlearned person it stands for would seem flawless too — the criticism collapses. The error is not about rarity, not a subject/object reversal, and not a literal identification of knowledge with fragrance; it is the loss of the 'something missing'.

28. (D) The simile's structure is 'attractive surface, absent inner essence': the coin's gleam = outward splendour = the किंशुक's COLOUR; the worthless metal = the missing inner worth = what the किंशुक's SCENTLESSNESS stands for. Pairing the gleam with scent inverts which feature is the deficiency. The coin lacks inner worth, so it cannot map to विद्या/शीलम् being PRESENT. And the दान/मद wealth-axis is a different verse, not the surface/substance simile.

29. (C) The verse says the knowledge-LESS do not truly shine despite looks, i.e. 'no विद्या ⇒ beauty alone fails'. The other conditionals invert or distort it: beauty does not cancel the need for knowledge; having knowledge does not guarantee beauty; and the verse never claims that lacking beauty nullifies the value of knowledge — it makes the OPPOSITE point, that knowledge is what truly adorns.

30. (B) An उपमा turns on the ABSTRACT property shared by both terms; here it is 'glorious outside, empty inside'. It is not literal redness (the person is not red), not a forest habitat (irrelevant to the unlearned), and certainly not fragrance — the किंशुक is scentLESS, so attributing rich fragrance to it inverts the very feature the simile exploits.

31. (D) He has abundant विद्या, so he is no मूर्ख (whose fault is ignorance, not malice); he chooses to harm, which is the खल's defect of WILL, and his learning serves wrongdoing, not knowledge-sharing. Learning does not auto-confer character, so he is not a साधु, and his use is the opposite of रक्षण. The किंशुक is a warning about empty beauty, not a label for corrupt eloquence, and his use is विवाद, not दान.

32. (B) A's shortfall is purely intellectual with no ill-will — a मूर्ख; B knowingly turns eloquence to harm — a खल; C uses learning well — a साधु. The learned CAN be wicked (that is exactly B), so swapping A and B's labels is wrong. Kindness/learning do not make C wicked, and not everyone imperfect is a खल — that erases the moral-vs-intellectual distinction the chapter draws.

33. (A) विद्या is studied, acquired learning; ज्ञान is direct, realised insight — distinct, so one can exist without the other, which the sage-vs-scholar case illustrates. Degrees do not guarantee insight, so 'much विद्या ⇒ equal ज्ञान' fails. ज्ञान is not confined to a school. And the two are NOT interchangeable, so asserting one without the other is coherent, not self-contradictory.

34. (A) Turning knowledge to quarrel or power to oppression is a deliberate moral choice, the signature of the खल; the मूर्ख's problem is lack of wisdom, not malice, so the verse

rightly targets the खल. A मूर्ख may well possess gifts (he simply uses them unwisely, not wickedly). खल and मूर्ख are NOT synonyms, and the मूर्ख is certainly not the praised साधु.

35. (C) The elder's failing is intellectual — ignorance without ill-will — which is exactly the मूर्ख. The minister twisting the law, the cheating trader, and the riot-spreading scholar all act with deliberate ill-will, turning their position or learning to harm — that is the खल (a moral fault), not the मूर्ख (an intellectual one).

36. (A) Worth, for the chapter, rests on शीलम्; lacking it he is a भारभूतः regardless of wealth, looks, or birth. Outward goods do NOT outweigh character — that reverses the doctrine. High birth does not guarantee good character. And the किंशुक image marks empty beauty as a WARNING; handsomeness does not 'supply scent' but is exactly the colour-without-scent the verse criticises.

37. (C) When wealth and looks are EQUAL, they cannot distinguish the cousins; only the differing quality — शीलम् — can. An equal trait cannot 'tip' a balance, so wealth or beauty cannot be the decider. And birth is not stated to differ here, so it cannot be invoked as the settling factor — the chapter's answer is character.

38. (D) The chapter ranks inner goods — character and rightly-used knowledge — above outward ones (beauty, wealth, birth). It does not put wealth/looks on top, nor birth alone, nor beauty: the किंशुक's colour is CRITICISED, not celebrated, so beauty cannot head the list. Only character-and-knowledge-above-the-rest matches the doctrine.

39. (D) Giving wealth to help others is दान, wealth's good use, and quiet generosity evidences शीलम्. It is the OPPOSITE of मद (self-glorifying pride), so calling display-free giving 'pride' is wrong. The verse explicitly treats wealth on the धन→दान/मद axis, so it is not silent about wealth. And giving makes one worthy, not a burden — depleting resources is not the chapter's notion of a भारभूत.

40. (A) लक्ष्मी is an ī-stem feminine (a goddess-name) declined with feminine endings and concord, exactly like नदी or यशस्विनी; the visarga is only the nom.-sg. marker, not a gender signal. Visarga-final words are not all masculine (लक्ष्मी: itself is feminine). Abstractions are not all neuter. And gender follows the noun's stem-class, not a supposed verbal origin.

41. (A) विपरीतम् ('opposite') is precisely what makes the same gift serve harm in the wicked and good in the साधु — a true statement. The किंशुक is a WARNING and is scentLESS, so 'its fragrance proves inner worth' is doubly false. शीलम् is glossed as वृत्तम्/आचरणम् (conduct), not wealth. And खल (a moral fault) is distinct from मूर्ख (an intellectual fault), so they are not the same.

42. (D) विपरीतम् is the pivot that opposes the wicked's and the good's uses of each gift; replacing it with समानम् ('same') would collapse that contrast and falsely equate the two. समानम् does not intensify a contrast — it erases it; it is the OPPOSITE of विपरीतम्, not a

synonym; and changing this one word does not turn a verse about people into one about flowers.

43. (C) वि- in विपरीत conveys turning-the-opposite-way (reversal); निर्- in निर्गन्ध conveys lack (privation) — two different prefix-senses. They are not both privative (विपरीत is not 'pathless'), not both intensive (निर्गन्ध is scentLESS, not 'very fragrant'), and the senses are as stated, not swapped between the two prefixes.

44. (A) Both attach a possessive suffix to a quality-stem to mean 'having' that quality — endowed with beauty / with fame. They are not privatives ('without'), which would be the opposite sense; not datives ('for'), which mark purpose; and not comparatives ('more than'), which would require a different formation. The shared idea is possession of the named quality.

45. (C) खलस्य and साधोः are genitives identifying whose use of the gifts is described — the wicked's versus the good's. They are not datives marking a recipient ('to'), not ablatives marking source ('from'), and not vocatives of address ('O...!'); each of those misreads the possessive/relational role of the genitive here.

46. (A) Worth needs शीलम् and right USE; a विद्वान् who lacks character, or who turns learning to quarrel, remains a burden despite his learning. So a learned person CAN be judged worthless. Acquiring विद्या does not destroy character — that is not the chapter's claim. And the chapter roots worth in character and well-used knowledge, not in wealth alone.

47. (A) Because identical gifts produce OPPOSITE outcomes depending on the holder, the gifts themselves are neutral and the user's character/intent decides their worth. No gift is intrinsically evil or good (power can be रक्षण or परिपीडन). The wicked really DO possess the gifts — they misuse them, so the comparison is real. And gifts do not automatically reform their holders — the खल proves that.

48. (D) Using power to protect is रक्षण — power's good use — which marks the साधु. Merely HAVING power is not oppression; only its misuse (परिपीडन) is, so he is no खल. Protection of the weak is substantive good, not a burden, so he is not a भारभूत. And protection is real worth, not the empty 'colour without scent' the किंशुक warns against.

49. (A) The verse is built on identical-source-but-opposite-use: दान and मद both spring from धन yet pull in contrary directions, which refutes 'treated alike'. They are not equivalent just for sharing a source. The premise that both stem from धन is actually CORRECT, so denying it is wrong. And neither belongs to विद्या or शक्ति — both are uses of wealth.

50. (B) Each link of the correct chain holds: having विद्या rules out मूर्ख, misusing it as विवाद marks the खल, and lacking शीलम् keeps his worth low. The other chains break: merely

having विद्या does not make one a साधु if it is misused; wealth and looks do not produce शीलम्; and being scentless-like-a-किंशुक signals EMPTINESS, not wisdom or worth.

51. (C) The किंशुक verse condemns splendour-without-substance and the शीलम् verse roots worth in character; together they make inner quality and right use decisive. They do not exalt outward splendour as the highest good, do not restrict the lesson to the unattractive or poor, and neither verse praises wealth or beauty — the किंशुक's colour is a warning, and शीलम् is about conduct.

52. (B) Both halves of the assertion are wrong: किंशुक is the particular tree whose scentlessness is the whole point of the simile, and खल (wickedness of will) is NOT the same as मूर्ख (foolishness of intellect). A full correction must fix BOTH errors, so options that concede किंशुक is 'any flower' or that खल equals मूर्ख leave one error standing; agreeing with the classmate leaves both.

53. (A) The continuation must reproduce the carried syllable; a vowel-initial verse does not carry the required consonant onset, so it is illegal. A vowel cannot freely substitute for a consonant-syllable — that ignores the matching rule. A bare-consonant ending does not free the next player to start with 'anything'. And vowel-initial verses are NOT forbidden in general; they are simply ineligible here because they fail to match this particular carry.

54. (D) The carry is the last PRONOUNCED syllable of the recited word रक्षणाय — the final य/या-coloured unit; antyakshari does not strip away the inflected ending before matching, so dropping -य to keep णा is wrong. The opener echoes the END, not the first syllable र. And the medial conjunct क्ष is internal, not final. The whole recited word's last syllable is what passes on.

55. (C) An akṣara is a syllable (consonant + vowel), and verses open on syllables, so matching syllables ensures the next opener is a genuine, pronounceable verse-start. Individual varṇas CAN be articulated in principle, so 'cannot be pronounced' is false. The last sound is not always a vowel (verses can close on a consonant-bearing syllable), so the two are not identical. And varṇa and akṣara are RELATED concepts, not random alternatives.

56. (C) He has abundant विद्या (so not a मूर्ख) but chooses to harm (the खल's defect of will), and lacking शीलम् his learning serves विवाद, leaving his worth low. Bad conduct is not the same as ignorance, so 'must be a मूर्ख' confuses moral and intellectual faults. Learning does not auto-confer character, so he is not a साधु. And विद्या alone does not guarantee worth — the whole chapter denies it.

57. (B) Both verses converge on this: inner quality plus right use decides worth, not the bare gift. 'More gifts ⇒ more worth' is exactly what the भारभूत-doctrine denies. Beauty and wealth alone are insufficient — that is the किंशुक's lesson. And knowledge HOWEVER used does not suffice, since misused विद्या (विवाद) marks the worthless खल — use matters.

58. (B) Same gift (wealth), विपरीत use: दान is other-directed giving, मद is self-directed pride — the difference is intent and direction, not quantity. The AMOUNT is irrelevant to the moral point (a larger fortune is not more virtuous). The SOURCE is not what the verse contrasts. And 'colour or form' of wealth is a category error, importing the किंशुक's surface-beauty image where it does not apply.

59. (D) मुक्तये is the dative (चतुर्थी) of मुक्ति, marking PURPOSE under तादर्थ्ये चतुर्थी — 'knowledge for the sake of liberation' — just as विवादाय and दानाय mark purpose in the verse. It is not a genitive ('of liberation'), not a locative ('in liberation'), and not an instrumental ('by knowledge'); each misreads the purpose-dative as another relation.

60. (C) The chapter grounds worth in well-used knowledge plus character, expressly subordinating beauty, wealth, birth and fame. Wealth-and-beauty alone is what the किंशुक and भारभूत verses reject; high birth alone does not confer worth; and fame 'however gained' ignores that the chapter cares about character and right use, not mere renown. Only विद्या-rightly-used-plus-शीलम् matches the doctrine.